

DoLS (Deprivation of Liberty Safeguards) – Quick Reference

■ *When to Apply*

- Person lacks capacity to consent to care or treatment
- Care arrangements involve continuous supervision and control
- Person is not free to leave
- Restrictions are necessary to keep the person safe
- No less restrictive option is available

■ *Process*

- Identify potential deprivation of liberty in care setting
- Complete DoLS application to local authority (supervisory body)
- Urgent authorisation can be applied if needed (up to 7 days)
- Best Interests Assessor (BIA) conducts assessment
- Authorisation granted, refused, or conditions applied

■ *Policy & Compliance*

- Follow Mental Capacity Act (MCA) principles
- Ensure care is least restrictive and in best interests
- Maintain clear documentation of decisions and assessments
- Regularly review DoLS authorisations and conditions
- Inform relatives/representatives and support advocacy rights

Stay compliant • Protect rights • Follow MCA & safeguarding guidance